

Interview and Questionnaire Questions

Interview Approach – Requirement Elicitation & Prototype Evaluation (Lecturers)

The interviews conducted for this project followed a semi-structured interview approach. Listed questions provide the primary structure for discussion. Additional follow-up questions were also asked depending on participant responses and discussion flow.

The interviews were taken for requirement elicitation and then for the incremental prototype evaluations to get the lecturer feedback for each increment. The stakeholder who was approached for interviews is Lecturer.

Questionnaire Approach - Requirement Elicitation (Students and Timetabling Team)

The questionnaire was conducted using Microsoft Forms to collect stakeholder feedback efficiently and in a structured manner.

The questionnaire targeted students and timetabling team members to gather information regarding current timetable communication experiences, common scheduling issues, and expectations for an improved timetable support system.

Demo and Evaluation Survey - Prototype Evaluation (Students)

The survey was conducted using Microsoft Forms to collect stakeholder feedback after the demonstration of the features developed for students. Survey focused on the email notification feature to get an idea how clear and complete the email they received is.

Demo and SUS Evaluation Form - Prototype Evaluation (Timetabling Team)

The SUS form was given to the timetabling team members using Microsoft Forms to collect their feedback after a small demonstration of the developed prototype (the features for the Timetabling Team).

List of Questions

Questions included under Sections A–C will be used within semi-structured interviews with the teachers/lecturers.

Sections D and E enlist the questions designed for surveys/questionnaires at the time of requirement elicitation for students and academics team.

Section F lists the semi-structured questions list that were asked during lecturer's interview.

Section G and F enlist the questions asked in the evaluation form for the students and the SUS-style evaluation statements for the timetabling team respectively.

A – Background Information

1. Role within the university?
(Student / Lecturer / Administrative Staff)
2. How frequently do you interact with the university timetable system?
3. What methods do you currently use to receive timetable updates or changes?

B – Current Timetabling Experience (Semi-Structured Interview)

4. Have you experienced timetable clashes or scheduling conflicts before?
5. What communication-related problems do you commonly face regarding timetable management?
6. How quickly do you usually receive timetable change notifications, and have you ever experienced missed or delayed updates?
7. Do you believe current timetable systems allow sufficient stakeholder involvement and transparency when changes occur? (Yes / No) (Reason for No)
8. Have timetable communication issues ever negatively affected your attendance, planning, or academic activities?

C – Requirement Gathering (Semi-Structured Interview)

9. What features would you like to see in an improved timetable support system? (any 1 or 2)
10. Would a centralised platform for timetable updates and change requests be useful for you? Why?
11. What difficulties do you face when requesting timetable changes or reporting scheduling issues?
12. Would you prefer real-time timetable updates? Why?
13. What information should be prioritised within timetable notifications?
14. Should students or lecturers be able to submit timetable-related concerns directly through the system?
15. What would make a timetable system feel more user-friendly for you?
16. Are there any existing systems or apps whose communication features you find useful?
17. What problems should the proposed system prioritise solving first?

D – Survey for Students

18. Have you experienced timetable clashes or scheduling conflicts before?
(Yes / No)
19. If yes, what was the main reason for the clash/conflict?
(Overlapping session times / Room double-booking / Late timetable change not communicated in time / Elective or module clash / Other)
20. Have you ever missed or received delayed timetable updates?
(Yes / No)
21. If yes, how often does this happen?
(Rarely / Occasionally / Frequently / Not sure)
22. How quickly do you usually receive timetable change notifications?
(Whenever the time for a session is updated / Sometimes / Never)
23. Would you prefer to receive timetable updates in real-time, as soon as a change is made?
(Yes / No / No strong preference)
24. Through which channel would you prefer to receive timetable notifications?
(Email / SMS/text message / Mobile app notification / University portal or dashboard alert)
25. What type of timetable changes are most important for you to be notified about?
(select all that apply) (Room changes / Time changes / Cancelled sessions / New or rescheduled sessions / Lecturer changes)
26. How much advance notice do you consider acceptable for a timetable change?
(Same day is fine / At least 24 hours / At least 2–3 days / At least a week)
27. Would you be interested in a single centralised place to view all timetable-related notifications, instead of checking multiple sources?
(Yes, very interested / Somewhat interested / Not interested)

E – Survey for Timetable Team (in case unavailability for interview)

28. Roughly how many requests do you deal with in a typical week?
(Fewer than 5 / 6–10 / 10–20 / More than 20)
29. What proportion of requests you receive require back-and-forth clarification before they can be processed?
(Very few / Some / Many / Most)
30. What's the most common reason a request is delayed or hard to process?
(select up to 2) (Missing information / Ambiguous or unclear request / Requires approval from someone else first / Conflicts with existing timetable / Other)
31. Do you think the current Microsoft Form captures the information you need to process requests efficiently?
(Yes / Somewhat / No)

32. How do you currently communicate the outcome/status of a request back to the requester?
(Email / They check the live timetable themselves / We don't routinely communicate outcomes / Other)
33. How useful would a dashboard showing all pending/in-progress/completed requests be for managing your workload?
(Very useful / Somewhat useful / Not useful)
34. How important is it to categorise incoming requests (e.g. by type, urgency, approval needed)?
(Very important / Somewhat important / Not important)
35. Would it help to have requests automatically checked against the live timetable (e.g. flagging if a room/time is already unavailable) before they reach you?
(Yes, would help / Maybe / No, wouldn't help)
36. Would you be comfortable with a system that lets requesters see the status/progress of their own request, without contacting you directly?
(Yes / Maybe, with some limits / No)
37. Would you support students being able to submit certain requests or issues directly, rather than only through academic staff?
(Yes / Maybe, for some issue types / No)
38. Is there anything about your current workflow that you think is important for this project to consider? (optional)

F – Prototype Evaluation Semi-Structured Questions – Interviews with Lecturer

23. Was the developed increment of the prototype easy to understand and navigate?
24. Did you experience any confusion while interacting with the prototype?
25. Which features did you find most useful?
26. Were there any features or workflows you found unclear or unnecessary?
27. Do you believe the proposed system could improve timetable communication efficiency?
28. What suggestions would you provide for improving the prototype further?

G – Prototype Evaluation Survey Questions – Email Notifications - Students

29. Did you receive the automated timetable notification email? (If No, you may skip all other questions and submit)
30. What type of timetable notification email did you receive? (Choose multiple, if you received more than one types)
31. How easy was it to understand what had happened to your timetable session?
32. How clear was the information provided in the email?
33. How easy was it to identify the important information (e.g., day, time, room or tutor) in the email?
34. Is there any information you think should be added to the notification?
35. Is there anything you would change about the notification or its design?
36. Overall, do you think this notification approach would improve communication about timetable changes at NTU?

H - SUS-Style Evaluation Statements – Timetabling Team

Participants may also be asked to rate the following statements on a scale from 1 (Strongly Disagree) to 5 (Strongly Agree):

- I think that I would like to use this system frequently.
- I found the system unnecessarily complex.
- I thought the system was easy to use.
- I think that I would need the support of a technical person to be able to use this system.
- I thought there was too much inconsistency in this system.
- I found the various functions in this system were well integrated.
- I would imagine that most people would learn to use this system very quickly.
- Overall Score for Constraint Requests
- Overall Score for Change Requests
- Overall Score for Notifications and 2-way Communication